



Plain Language Talking Points COMMUNITY LIVING

WHAT IS THE PROBLEM?

- » The waiting lists to get Medicaid-funded community services are too long. These are services like help with money, job coaching in employment, housekeeping and running a home, and transportation support to be able to live independently.
- » People waiting for services do not have help if they do not want to live in nursing homes or institutions.
- » Direct support workers need to be paid well.
- » Programs cannot find enough direct support workers and afford to pay them what they need to keep them.

WHY IT MATTERS TO ME:

- » I value my (or my friends or loved one's) ability to live in the community, near friends and family with help when they need it.
- » My friends or loved ones and I deserve access to community programs without incredibly long waiting lists.
- » We want to be able to pay workers enough so they can continue to work with people with disabilities.
- » I want to live somewhere that I can be safe, happy, healthy, and as independent as possible.

WHAT CAN CONGRESS DO?

- » Congress should invest in more Home and Community Based Service (HCBS) programs and pay workers better wages. HCBS include help with living independently, getting around the community, support for employment, and other daily activities.
- » Congress should make HCBS services available for all who need them and end waiting lists.